
BUYER TIPS
BUYING? READ IT FIRST.
YOUR BUYER AGREEMENT, EXPLAINED.
A written buyer agreement spells out the services your agent provides and how they're paid (NAR)
You'll be asked to sign one before touring a home with an agent, in person or virtually (NAR)
Here's what I recommend checking first
BUYER TIPS
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THE MARKET

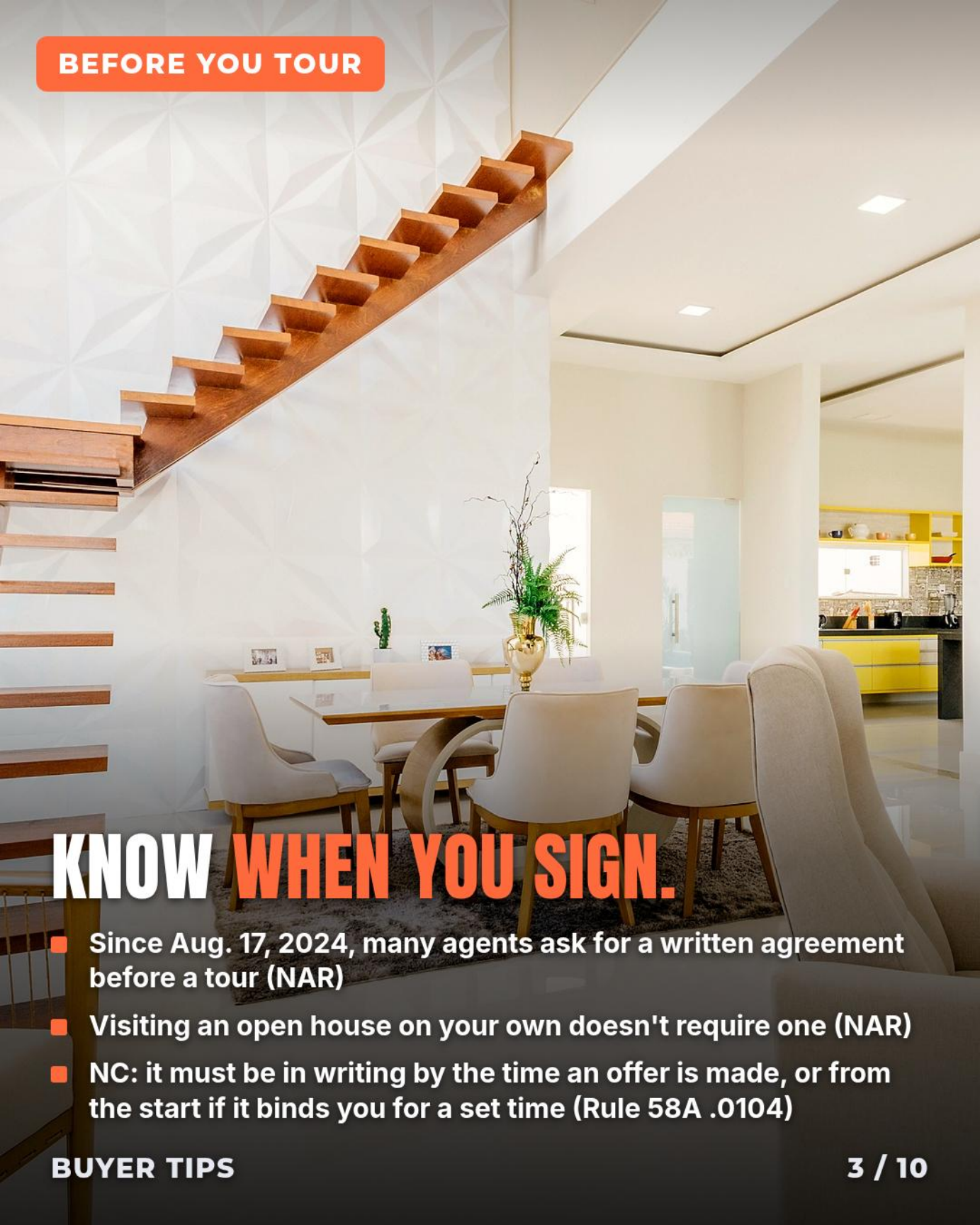
CHARLOTTE METRO, NC + SC

SEPTEMBER 2026.

ACTIVE LISTINGS	11,182	+10.3% YoY
LISTINGS WITH A PRICE CUT	26.2%	+0.7 pts YoY
MEDIAN LIST PRICE	$424,950	−3.1% YoY
MEDIAN DAYS ON MARKET	64	+10.3% YoY

More homes to choose from than a year earlier. Read your agreement before the tours start.

Source: Realtor.com Economic Research, Charlotte-Concord-Gastonia, NC-SC metro, September 2026



BEFORE YOU TOUR

KNOW WHEN YOU SIGN.

- Since Aug. 17, 2024, many agents ask for a written agreement before a tour (NAR)
- Visiting an open house on your own doesn't require one (NAR)
- NC: it must be in writing by the time an offer is made, or from the start if it binds you for a set time (Rule 58A .0104)



HOW PAY WORKS

PAY IS NEGOTIABLE.

- Agent compensation isn't set by law; it's negotiated (NAR)
- It must be clearly defined, like a flat fee or a percent, not open-ended or a range (NAR)
- SC: the agreement states the fee or how it's figured, and when it's earned (S.C. Code 40-57-135)



WHO PAYS

ASK WHO PAYS.

- You're responsible for what your agreement says you'll pay (NAR)
- You can still request and negotiate for the seller to pay your agent (NAR)
- Ask how a seller-paid amount is handled before you sign



CHECK THE DATES.

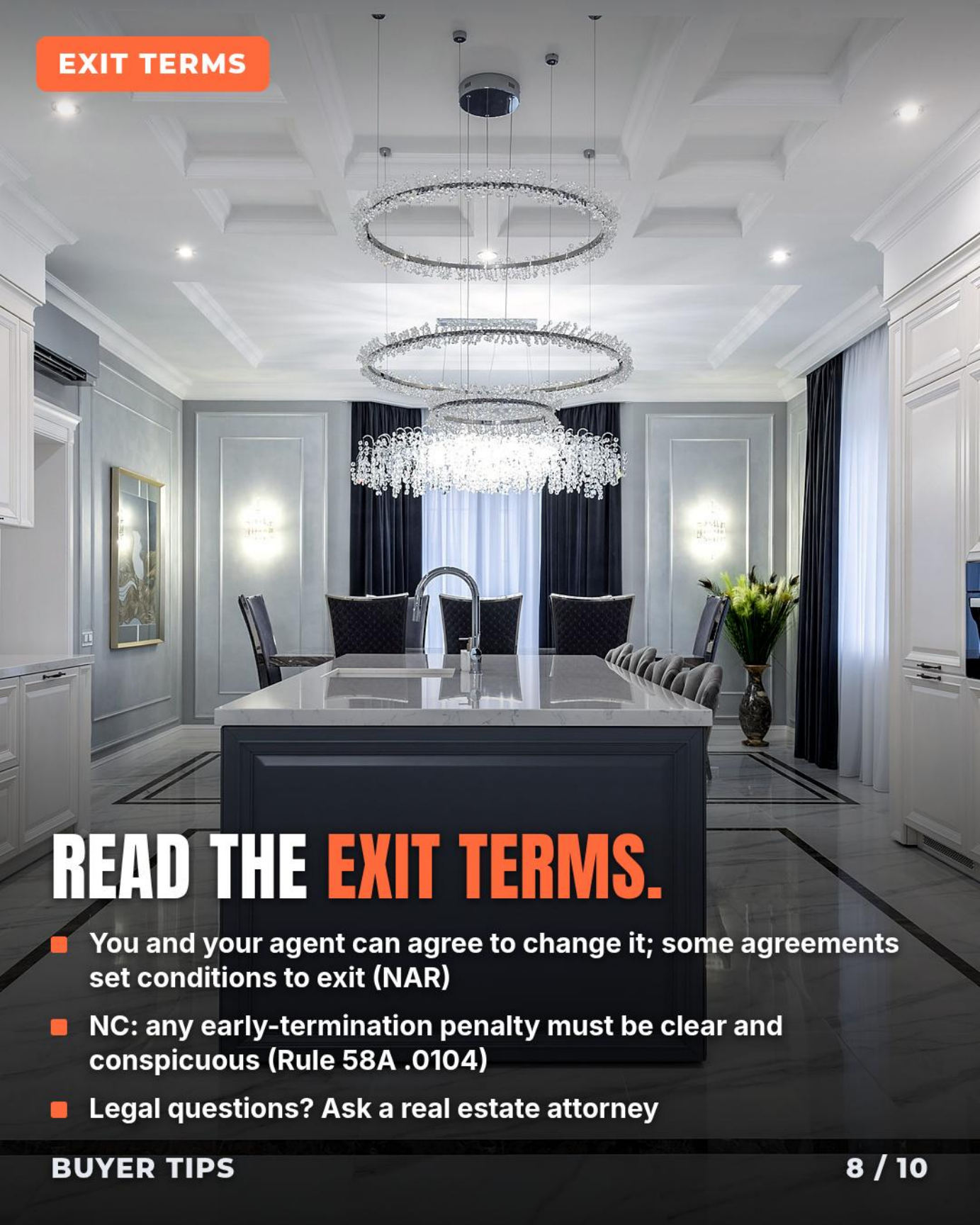
- NC: it runs for a definite period and ends at expiration without notice (Rule 58A .0104)
- SC: it sets start and end dates and ends then unless you sign a written extension (S.C. Code 40-57-135)
- Ask how long the term is and why



WHICH TYPE

KNOW WHICH TYPE.

- SC: where it applies, the agreement must clearly state which type it is (S.C. Code 40-57-135)
- NC: an agreement that limits your right to work with other agents must be in writing from the start (Rule 58A .0104)
- Ask whether you can work with other agents while it's in effect



EXIT TERMS

READ THE EXIT TERMS.

- You and your agent can agree to change it; some agreements set conditions to exit (NAR)
- NC: any early-termination penalty must be clear and conspicuous (Rule 58A .0104)
- Legal questions? Ask a real estate attorney



DISCLOSURES

KNOW YOUR DISCLOSURES.

- NC: you get the "Working with Real Estate Agents" brochure at first substantial contact (Rule 58A .0104)
- NC: one firm may represent both sides only with each party's written authority (Rule 58A .0104)
- SC: dual agency needs your written consent before an offer is written (S.C. Code 40-57-350)

MY RECOMMENDATION



ASK FOR IT BEFORE YOU TOUR.

I recommend asking to see the buyer agreement before your first tour, so you can read every line and ask questions first. Let's go through it together.

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Equal Housing Opportunity